

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1349

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Stephanie Jan Halaiko Chivers of Kingston Springs.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of former State Representative Stephanie Jan Halaiko Chivers; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Chivers was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Harrisburg, Pennsylvania, on March 1, 1934, to Stephen and Martha Halaiko, Stephanie Chivers distinguished herself early as a student athlete, playing tennis at The Pennsylvania State University before embarking upon a remarkable career in public service and politics; and

WHEREAS, in 1961, she married her beloved husband, Noel K. Chivers, with whom she raised two sons, Rusty and Tom; and

WHEREAS, a pioneering figure in Tennessee politics, Mrs. Chivers was the first female Republican ever elected to the Tennessee House of Representatives from Shelby County; and

WHEREAS, her distinguished career in public service included her tenure in the administration of President George H.W. Bush in the Office of Presidential Personnel, as well as her service as an assistant commissioner in the Department of Commerce and Insurance under Governor Don Sundquist; and

WHEREAS, widely respected for her political acumen and leadership, Stephanie Chivers served as a longtime senior advisor to United States Senator Lamar Alexander and was elected by the Tennessee Republican Party State Executive Committee as Republican National Committeewoman in 2000; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Chivers's extensive involvement in political campaigns included service as Tennessee co-chair of Bush-Cheney 2000, work on Bob Corker's United States Senate campaign, volunteer service for Governor Bill Haslam, and participation in numerous state and local campaigns; and

WHEREAS, in 2002, she garnered national attention when, in her official capacity, she granted a boxing license to Mike Tyson for a fight in Memphis; and

WHEREAS, throughout her career, Stephanie Chivers mentored and guided the careers of countless young women and men in government, politics, business, and community service; and

WHEREAS, beyond her many professional accomplishments, Mrs. Chivers was an avid sports fan who especially enjoyed tennis, golf, and football, and she found great pleasure in reading, bird-watching, and indulging her fondness for sweet treats; and

WHEREAS, her greatest joy was found in the company of her family, friends, and beloved pets, and she took immense pride in her children and grandchildren, delighting in loving and spoiling them; and

WHEREAS, Stephanie Chivers departed this life on February 16, 2026, peacefully surrounded by her loved ones in the comfort of her home in Kingston Springs; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, she was preceded in death by her sisters, Toni, Marcia, and Patricia, and her daughter-in-law, Lacy; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Chivers is survived by her beloved husband, Noel; her brother, Billy Halaiko; her sons, Rusty (Lacy) Chivers and Tom (Samantha) Chivers; her grandchildren, Jessica (Doug) Taggart, Caitlyn (Cody) Anderson, Lila Chivers, Witt Chivers, Max Chivers, and Avie Chivers; her great-grandchildren, Alexis Taggart, Abram Taggart, Revel Anderson, and Alden Anderson; and many extended family members and dear friends; and

WHEREAS, a cherished friend, mentor, and leader, Stephanie Chivers touched the lives of all who knew her with her warmth, generosity, and rare ability to form meaningful and lasting connections; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Stephanie Jan Halaiko Chivers, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character, her extraordinary life of service, and her enduring legacy of leadership and compassion.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to the family of Mrs. Chivers.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.